

THE SUN

Our local star, the Sun, is the hub of the Solar System. Because it is so massive, it holds the planets in orbit with its mighty gravity. It is also a colossal nuclear reactor. At its core, which sears at 15 million °C (59 million °F), the Sun fuses hydrogen into helium, creating the heat and light that makes life possible on Earth.

The core, the powerhouse of the Sun, is 10 times denser than gold

DATA FILE



DIAMETER: 1.4 million km
(864,900 miles)



TYPE: Yellow main sequence



SURFACE TEMPERATURE:
5,500°C (9,930°F)



DISTANCE FROM EARTH:
149.6 million km (93 million miles)